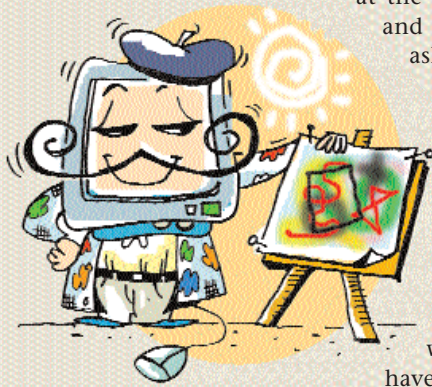


ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR

If you want a top of the line graphics program that deals with both raster and vector graphics, Adobe Illustrator 10 is the software for you. Use these small time saving tips to get the best out of this powerful tool.



at the palette's bottom, and say yes, when asked if you want to delete the selected styles. Follow the same procedure for brushes, swatches and symbols (symbols are in AI 10 only). You will now only have items used in the document in the palette. Next, delete the objects using the styles from the page. New styles are stored in the styles palette. Save the file, give it a descriptive name, and close it. Remember, the file must be closed to load the styles.

To use the styles, go to **Window > Style Libraries > Other Library**, and navigate to where you saved the file. Highlight it and click Open to open it. The styles will be in the styles palette, ready for use.

Transferring vectors between Illustrator and Photoshop

Vectors are important as they are resolution independent—so they can be scaled up or down with no loss of detail—and they

print clean, and crisp. Vector shapes can be easily modified; just a little tug on a handle turns a line into a curve. Vectors can be easily rasterized into pixels; it takes specialised programs to convert pixels into vectors. If vectors could be transferred between different programs, it would be a very handy feature. Here is how we can do it between Photoshop and Illustrator.

From Photoshop to Illustrator

Between Illustrator 9 and Photoshop 6, you can drag and drop paths, directly from Photoshop into Illustrator. Previously, you could only export, or copy, and paste. Just select the Photoshop path, and drag it to an open Illustrator document.

Export paths from Photoshop, by going to **File > Export > Paths to Illustrator**. You can choose a specific path from the Paths palette, a path from a shape layer, or crop marks that define the Photoshop file size. Note that the path exported to Illustrator, will have no fill, or stroke. Select all, or switch to the outline mode to see your vectors.

From Illustrator to Photoshop

You can also get vectors from Illustrator into Photoshop. If you select the Illustrator objects, and then copy and paste, a dialog box appears that lets you control whether you want the path converted into pixels (on their own layer), paths

(added to Photoshop's Paths palette), or shapes (as a new shape layer).

Photoshop lets you control the conversion from precious vectors to bland pixels. If you choose pixels, a transformation box appears around the imported art work. Use the bounding box handles to scale, rotate, or skew the art work any which way you want. As long as you don't double-click, or press [Enter], you've still got resolution-independent vectors.

Finally, if you want to drag and drop from Illustrator into Photoshop, you can control the created object type as follows. With no key pressed, drag to create a pixel layer. Hold [Ctrl] to create a path. If a shape layer is currently active, the path will be added to that shape layer. Hold [Shift] and place the new object in the centre of the Photoshop file.

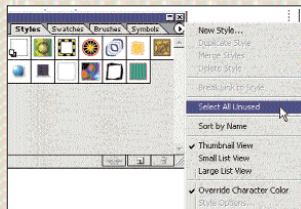
Make your own gift tags

You can create your own tags that are business card sized to put on gift boxes. By default, the 0 on the ruler is set to the left side horizontally, and the bottom vertically. Change it by clicking on the crosshairs on the rulers' top, and dragging it to the top left corner.

Unfortunately, you can't change the page margins in Illustrator. They're set to the unprintable area of your printer. You can move them around on the page, but you

Create custom styles

To create custom styles, set up objects with the strokes and fills you want to save as styles. Drag each of them to the styles palette. Do not delete them from the page yet. On the Styles palette, click the options triangle,



Create your custom styles and use them later to ease your work and attain consistency

and choose 'Select all unused'.

The unused styles are selected. Click the trash can